

KYLE B. LEIGHTON

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Senior SDET | Test Automation Engineering (Web, Mobile, API) | Appium, XCUITest, Espresso | Playwright, Selenium | CI/CD

Senior SDET with 10+ years of experience designing and scaling automated test frameworks across web, mobile, and API platforms. Proven ability to build automation systems from the ground up, integrate them into CI/CD pipelines, and drive engineering-led quality across distributed teams.

Brings rare cross-platform depth — equally effective in web UI automation (Playwright/Selenium), API validation, and native mobile automation (Appium, Espresso, XCUITest). Strong hands-on experience in Swift and Kotlin environments, enabling deep collaboration with mobile engineering teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Web & UI Automation: Playwright, Selenium WebDriver, Cucumber (BDD), cross-browser testing

API & Integration Testing: REST APIs, Postman, contract testing, API validation

Mobile Automation: Appium, Espresso, XCUITest (iOS & Android)

Languages: Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, C#, Kotlin, Swift, SQL

Framework Design: Page Object Model, Modular Architecture, Reusable Libraries

CI/CD & DevOps: Azure DevOps, Jenkins, Git, Parallel Test Execution

Tools: Xcode, Android Studio, JIRA, Confluence, Postman

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chipotle Mexican Grill

Nov 2025 – Present

Senior SDET — Mobile & Platform Automation | Newport Beach, CA (Hybrid)

- Build and maintain scalable iOS (Swift/XCUITest) and Android (Kotlin/Espresso) automation frameworks integrated into Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines for a high-traffic consumer application used by millions.
- Designed and built a backend-driven API utility layer from scratch using Postman collections and endpoint contracts, creating reusable readers, data injectors, pollers, and validators to enable reliable API-driven test setup and validation.
- Configured Azure DevOps YAML pipelines to run iOS UI smoke tests as optional PR checks, enabling early regression signal on every pull request.
- Partner with mobile engineers through sprint planning, defect isolation, debugging, and release cycles to improve overall release confidence.

Career Sabbatical

Dec 2024 – Nov 2025

Entrepreneurial & Technical Pursuit

- Built and operated two independent businesses, designing systems for client intake, scheduling, and delivery workflows.
- Developed automated processes and lightweight systems applying engineering principles to real-world operations.
- Strengthened product thinking, ownership, and system design skills.

Embeta

Jul 2023 – Jan 2025

Staff Software Test Engineer

- Built and scaled a 29-device automation lab using Appium/C#, reducing regression cycle time by 60% through parallel CI/CD execution.
- Drove automation strategy across mobile, web, API, and device-integrated systems.
- Designed scalable automation frameworks adaptable across multiple testing layers.
- Partnered with engineering teams on defect triage, code reviews, and release quality decisions.
- Reduced tooling costs by \$33K annually through infrastructure optimization.

Boston Scientific

Nov 2020 – Jul 2023

Senior Software QA Engineer

- Delivered automated test coverage across Android, iOS, and web platforms using Appium and Playwright.
- Built reusable automation components supporting both mobile and web testing.
- Expanded end-to-end system coverage across multiple integrated software layers.
- Collaborated with engineering teams on design reviews, bug triage, and quality strategy.

Medtronic

Feb 2016 – Oct 2020

Software Test Engineer — Mobile & Platform Systems

- Architected scalable automation frameworks using Appium and Java across 30+ device and OS configurations.
- Converted manual test suites into automated coverage, reducing execution time from 30 days to 4 hours.
- Developed reusable libraries and automation utilities improving development efficiency.
- Mentored engineers in automation best practices and framework design.

EDUCATION

California State University, Fullerton

2019

Master of Science — Software Engineering

University of California, Santa Barbara

2010

Bachelor of Arts — History